

Clever ways to cure compatibility ills

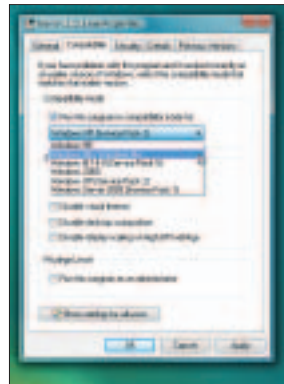
Having problems running programs? We offer tips on ironing out compatibility hassles

Vista is one of the most significant upgrades that Microsoft has ever released, and just about every aspect of the operating system has been rewritten to make it better. It does have a down side, though: all these changes mean some old applications won't install or run properly on your new setup.

If this is the case then your first step should be to look for an update for the program in question. Try checking the author's support site (there's often a link on the Help menu), or search for your application at Google to find more advice. The official Windows Vista Application Compatibility Update (<http://support.microsoft.com/kb/943302>) also improves support for many applications and is worth installing, even if it doesn't support your program. If that doesn't work, don't give up — here are some more tricks you can try.

Tip 1

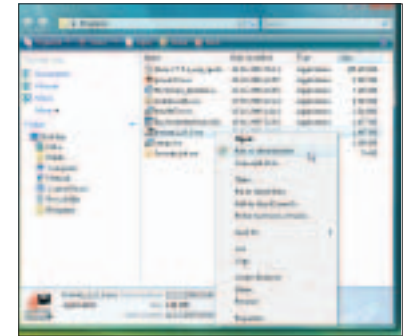
Locate the shortcut icon for your problem program (either on your desktop or from the Start menu). Right-click on it and select Properties > Compatibility. Put a check next to 'Run this program in compatibility mode', choose a version of Windows the program previously worked with and click OK. Now launch the program again. Windows Vista will try to fool it into thinking it's running under an older version of Windows, hopefully solving the problem. If it doesn't, return to the Compatibility Mode screen, check all the Settings boxes and try running the program again. If you can't find an icon



for the program, or just need more help getting this to work, click Start > Control Panel > Programs > Use an older program with this version of Windows. This will launch the Program Compatibility Wizard, which will walk you through the configuration process.

Tip 2

The new Windows Vista security schemes will sometimes cause compatibility issues. It's annoying but fortunately very easy to fix. Just right-click on the icon for your program and select 'Run as Administrator'. The application will then be able to behave just as it did in the days of XP, and may now run without difficulty. If you find this helps you, right-click on the program's icon again, select Properties > Compatibility, check the Privilege Level box and click OK. It'll now run this way all the time, without you having to right-click each time. Running something as an Administrator is a powerful technique, but always remember why: you are, in effect, turning off Windows Vista security for the application. Only do this with programs you completely trust, never something you've just found online.



Tip 3

Some applications are nearly Vista compatible, with only a couple of areas causing problems, so a little tweak can make all the difference. If your program is already installed, remove it (Start > Control Panel > Uninstall a Program) and start the setup process again. Choose the Custom installation option, or whatever gives you the most control over the installation settings. Install as few

